# Margin & Cash Multi-Brokerage Tracker: User Guide

Every tab, every column and every menu item, in plain English

The tracker is built around one idea: you type each transaction once, in the Transaction Log, and every other tab updates by itself. The only other place you type is the amber cells on Settings & Goals. Everything green is a formula: leave it alone and it will always be right.

| Colour | Meaning |
|---|---|
| **Amber** | Your input. Type here (Settings & Goals). |
| **Blue** | A dropdown. Pick from the list (Institution, Account, Type, Currency). |
| **White** | Manual entry in the Transaction Log (date, ticker, shares, price, amount). |
| **Green** | A formula. Do not type here. |

**Your template link:** https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1RpKf9hveoAwjKRrP5i00mIAi3wNNvVh_oKFbht-9prw/copy (opens Make a copy).

## THE MAPLESHEET MENU

| Menu item | What it does |
|---|---|
| **Build / Rebuild All Tabs** | Builds every tab. Safe to run again: it keeps your Settings inputs and Transaction Log rows. |
| **Sort Transaction Log by Date** | Puts every row in date order. Run it if column P says "Date out of order": the running ACB follows the order of the rows. |
| **Load Sample Data** | Fills the Transaction Log with a sample investor using Questrade and RBC (margin) and Wealthsimple (cash). Purchase prices are set from today's prices. Replaces anything in the log. |
| **Clear Sample Data** | Empties the Transaction Log. Formulas, dropdowns and Settings stay. |
| **Rebuild Dashboard Charts** | Redraws the two Main Dashboard charts if one goes blank. |
| **About** | Shows the version. |

**First time you use the menu.** Google shows an "Authorization required" box. Click Continue, choose your Google account, then Advanced and Allow. The script only works inside your own copy of the sheet.

## 1. SETTINGS & GOALS: SET UP ONCE, UPDATE EACH JANUARY

| Cell | What to enter | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| **B5 to B7** | Your name, province and Active Year (the tax year you are tracking). | Change B7 every January. |
| **B8** | Your approximate marginal tax rate. | Only used to estimate the after-tax cost of margin interest. |
| **B9** | The loan-to-value that should trigger a warning (50% by default). | Margin loan ÷ value of your margin-account holdings. |
| **B13 to B20** | Up to 8 brokerages. Leave a slot blank to hide it. | Use exactly the same name every time. |
| **C13 to C20** | Each brokerage's yearly margin rate (for example 7.00%). | Leave blank for a cash-only account. Rates follow the prime rate: check yours a few times a year. |
| **B38 to B40** | Investment income goal, portfolio value goal and income yield target. | Your own plan. |

| Cell | What to enter | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| **B43 to B44** | Default currency and an optional USD/CAD rate. | Leave B44 blank to use the live rate. |

B23 to B27 hold the numbers the formulas use: the 50% capital gains inclusion rate, the 38% eligible dividend gross-up, the 15.0198% federal dividend tax credit, 15% US withholding and the 30-day superficial loss window. The rest of the tab is a quick tax reference and two checklists, one for December and one for January.

## 2. TRANSACTION LOG: THE ONLY TAB YOU TYPE INTO

One row per transaction, starting on row 4, in date order. Never delete old rows: your ACB depends on the full history. **Already own shares?** Log each position once as a Buy, dated the day you start, with column L = your current ACB for it.

| Col | Column | What to enter |
|---|---|---|
| **A** | Date | The trade or payment date (yyyy-mm-dd). |
| **B** | Year | Automatic. |
| **C** | Institution | Dropdown from Settings B13:B20. |
| **D** | Account | Margin (you can borrow) or Cash (no borrowing). Both are non-registered, taxable accounts. |
| **E** | Type | Dropdown, see the table below. |
| **F** | Ticker | With the exchange prefix: TSE:RY, TSE:XEQT, NASDAQ:AAPL, NYSE:JPM. Leave blank for deposits and interest. |
| **G** | Description | Anything that helps you remember. |
| **H** | Currency | CAD or USD. |
| **I** | Shares / Units | For Buy, Sell, DRIP and transfers. |
| **J** | Price / Share | For Buy, Sell and DRIP. |
| **K** | Commission | Optional. |
| **L** | Amt (Original) | The total in the original currency. Leave it blank on a Buy or Sell and it fills itself (Buy = shares × price + commission, Sell = shares × price – commission). |
| **M** | FX Rate | Automatic: 1 for CAD, live USD/CAD (or your override) for USD. |
| **N** | Amt (CAD) | Automatic. Every dashboard adds up this column. |
| **O** | Realized Gain / Loss | Automatic, on every Sell: proceeds minus the ACB of the shares sold, using your average cost across ALL brokerages. |
| **P** | Check | Automatic warnings: date out of order, ticker missing, selling more than you hold, possible superficial loss. |

| Type | Use it for |
|---|---|
| **Deposit / Withdrawal** | Cash in or out. Amount in column L. A withdrawal from a Margin account adds to your loan. |
| **Buy / Sell** | Shares, price and commission. Column L fills itself if you leave it blank. |
| **Dividend** | Cash dividend. Log US dividends at the GROSS amount, before the 15% US tax withheld. |
| **DRIP** | A dividend reinvested in new shares: enter the shares and the price. It is still taxable income. |
| **Interest Income** | Interest your broker pays on cash. |
| **Margin Interest** | The interest your broker charges on your margin loan, one row a month. Account = Margin. |
| **Fee** | Account or admin fees. Generally not deductible. |

| Type | Use it for |
|---|---|
| **Return of Capital** | An ETF distribution that lowers your ACB (T3 box 42). Amount in column L. |
| **Reinvested Distribution** | A "phantom" capital-gain distribution kept inside an ETF. It raises your ACB. Amount in column L. |
| **Transfer Out / Transfer In** | Shares moved in-kind between your own accounts at two brokerages. Log both sides, same day, same shares. It is not a sale. |

**How the pooled ACB works.** The CRA averages the cost of identical shares across every non-registered account you own. Buy 120 ENB at Questrade and 40 ENB at RBC, and all 160 shares share one average cost. Each sale uses that average, whichever brokerage it happens at. Your broker's "book value" only knows its own shares, so it can be different: use this tracker's number for your taxes.

## 3. MAIN DASHBOARD

| Section | What it shows |
|---|---|
| **Brokerage cards** | One column per brokerage plus a Combined Total: market value, ACB, unrealized gain/loss, cash balance (negative = margin loan), your equity, investment income this year and margin interest this year. |
| **Leverage & break-even** | Your total margin loan, loan-to-value against your warning level, average margin rate, a full year of interest at today's loan, the break-even yield, your income yield and the after-tax cost. The message line tells you the one thing to watch. |
| **Tax snapshot** | Net capital gain, taxable capital gain, taxable dividends, foreign income, the Line 22100 interest deduction and how many rows need checking. |
| **Last 5 transactions and goals** | Your latest entries, and progress bars for your income and portfolio goals. |
| **Charts** | Market value and margin loan by brokerage, and margin interest vs income month by month. |

## 4. PORTFOLIO

Every stock and ETF you own, all brokerages combined: shares, average cost (ACB per share), ACB, live price in CAD, market value, unrealized gain/loss, return %, realized gain/loss this year and income this year. US tickers (NYSE:, NASDAQ:) are converted to CAD at the live rate.

## 5. INSTITUTION DASHBOARD

The same cards side by side for up to 8 brokerages, with more detail: margin rate, estimated monthly interest, interest paid, income, sell proceeds (to compare with each broker's T5008) and realized gain/loss this year. Use it to see which broker charges you the most and where your gains are.

## 6. MARGIN INTEREST

| Item | How it is worked out |
|---|---|
| **Margin loan** | For each brokerage: deposits + sells + dividends + interest received – withdrawals – buys – margin interest – fees, in Margin rows. If that is negative, it is your loan. You never type it in. |
| **Loan-to-value** | Loan ÷ value of the holdings in that brokerage's Margin account. |
| **Estimated monthly interest** | Loan × that brokerage's rate ÷ 12. Compare it with what your statement charges. |
| **Break-even yield** | A full year of interest at today's loan ÷ the value of your margin holdings: what they must earn just to pay for the borrowing. |

| Item | How it is worked out |
|---|---|
| **Income yield** | Dividends, DRIP and interest in your Margin accounts this year, annualized, ÷ the same holdings. |
| **Monthly table** | Interest paid vs income received each month of the Active Year, with a chart. |

## 7. DIVIDEND TRACKER

Eight summary cards (all-time and this-year dividends and DRIP, monthly average, full-year estimate, your goal and progress), Section A month by month against your monthly target, Section B every dividend and DRIP with its brokerage, and Section C a per-ticker summary with an annual run rate.

## 8. TAX SUMMARY

| Line | What the tracker gives you |
|---|---|
| **12000** | Taxable amount of eligible dividends: CAD dividends and DRIP × 1.38. |
| **40425** | Federal dividend tax credit: 15.0198% of the taxable amount. |
| **12100** | US dividends (gross) + interest income. |
| **40500** | Estimated foreign tax credit: 15% of US dividends. |
| **12700** | Taxable capital gains: 50% of your net gain, all brokerages, pooled ACB. |
| **22100** | Margin interest paid in the year. |
| **T5008 check** | Sell proceeds, ACB and gain/loss per brokerage. Proceeds should match box 21 of that broker's T5008. |
| **Every sale** | A list of each sale this year with its ACB and gain/loss, ready for Schedule 3. |

The Tax Summary is an estimate to help you file. Your T5, T3 and T5008 slips are the final word on income amounts. CAD dividends are assumed to be eligible: ETF distributions can also contain interest, capital gains or return of capital, so use the T3 breakdown for those.

## 9. TAX & MARGIN RULES

Every rule that matters when you hold taxable accounts at more than one brokerage, as colour-coded cards: red for costly mistakes, amber for limits and deadlines, green for benefits. The Tax & Margin Rules PDF explains each one in more detail.

## EVERY JANUARY

1. **Make a copy (optional)**
   File, Make a copy, named for the new year. Or keep one file: the log holds all history.
2. **Change the Active Year**
   Settings B7, for example 2026 to 2027. All "this year" numbers switch to the new year.
3. **Check your margin rates**
   Settings C13:C20. Brokers change them when the prime rate moves.
4. **Keep logging**
   Add new transactions below the old ones. Your ACB carries forward automatically.

## TROUBLESHOOTING

| Problem | Fix |
|---|---|
| **A price shows $0.00** | Check the ticker prefix: TSE: for Toronto, NYSE: or NASDAQ: for US, NEO: for Cboe Canada. GOOGLEFINANCE can also pause for a few minutes. |
| **A gain or loss looks wrong** | Check column P for "Date out of order" and run Sort Transaction Log by Date. Make sure every Buy and DRIP for that ticker is logged, at every brokerage. |
| **The margin loan looks wrong** | Every deposit, withdrawal, buy, sell, dividend and interest charge at that brokerage must be logged with Account = Margin. Compare with the cash balance on your statement. |
| **A transaction is missing from a dashboard** | Check the Institution name matches Settings exactly, the Type is from the dropdown, and the date is a real date. |
| **"This year" numbers are $0** | Settings B7 (Active Year) does not match the year of your transactions. |
| **A chart is blank** | MapleSheet menu, Rebuild Dashboard Charts. |
| **Something broke** | MapleSheet menu, Build / Rebuild All Tabs. Your inputs and transactions are kept. |

For educational purposes only. Not financial or tax advice. Rules summarized for 2026 (federal) from canada.ca and Income Tax Folio S3-F6-C1. Always confirm your own situation with a tax professional. Questions: hello@maplesheet.ca